

3	(a)	(i)	Explain what is meant by an <i>ideal gas</i> .	
				
				[2]
			An ideal gas is one that obeys the ideal gas equation $pV = nRT$	1
			at all values of temperature (T), pressure (p) and volume (V), where n is the number of moles of gas and R is the molar gas constant.	1
		(ii)	Use the kinetic theory of gases to explain why when the volume of an ideal gas decreases at constant temperature, the pressure of the gas increases.	
				
				
				
				
				
				
				
				
				[4]
			When temperature is constant, the root-mean-square speed of the gas atoms is constant.	1
			Therefore, when volume decreases , the distance travelled by the atoms between successive collisions with a wall of the container decreases, leading to a higher frequency of collisions between the gas atoms and the wall of the container.	1
			A higher frequency of collisions leads to greater total <u>rate</u> of <u>change</u> of momentum of all the molecules hitting a wall at any instant in time	1
			and thus larger force on the container , thus a higher pressure.	1

- (b) A fixed amount of an ideal gas undergoes a cycle of changes $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$ as shown in Fig. 3.1.

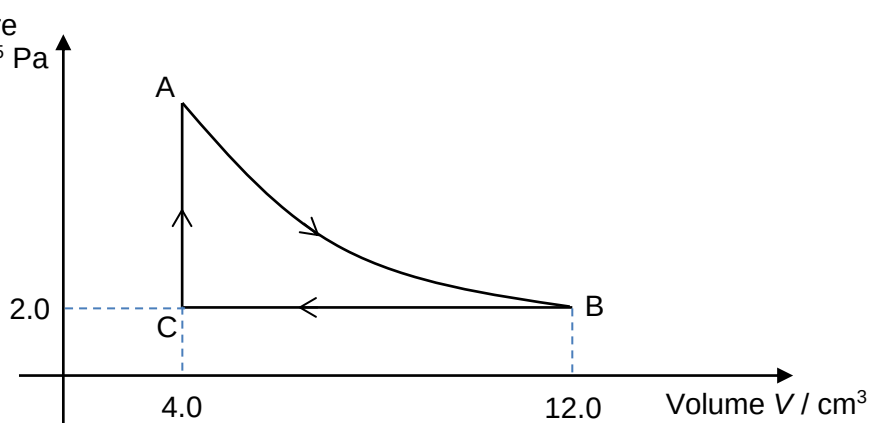


Fig. 3.1

- (i) Determine the work done on the ideal gas during the process $B \rightarrow C$.

work done on gas = J [2]

$$W = -p\Delta V$$

$$W = -(2.0 \times 10^5)(4.0 - 12.0)(10^{-6})$$

$$W = 1.6 \text{ J}$$

1
1

- (ii) Explain why there is a net thermal energy absorbed by the ideal gas when it undergoes a cycle of changes $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$.

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[3]

Per cycle, total work done by gas is greater than total work done on the gas, thus there is a net work done by gas.

1

Per cycle, there is no net change in the internal energy of the ideal gas.

1

1

			Thus, by the First Law of Thermodynamics, $\Delta U = Q + W$, with a net work done by the gas, there needs to be a net thermal energy supplied to the gas so that there is no net change in the internal energy.	

4	The variation with potential difference V of current I in a resistor X is shown in Fig. 4.1
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